

'But, monsieur, they cried "Vive Colbert!"' replied the trembling watch.

'A handful of conspirators—'

'No, no; a mass of people.'

'Ah! indeed,' said Colbert, expanding. 'A mass of people cried "Vive Colbert!" Are you certain of what you say, monsieur?'

'We had nothing to do but open our ears, or rather to close them, so terrible were the cries.'

'And this was from the people, the real people?'

'Certainly, monsieur; only these real people beat us.'

'Oh! very well,' continued Colbert, thoughtfully. 'Then you suppose it was the people alone who wished to burn the condemned?'

'Oh! yes, monsieur.'

'That is quite another thing. You strongly resisted, then?'

'We had three of our men crushed to death, monsieur!'

'But you killed nobody yourselves?'

'Monsieur, a few of the rioters were left upon the square, and one among them who was not a common man.'

'Who was he?'

'A certain Menneville, upon whom the police have a long time had an eye.'

'Menneville!' cried Colbert, 'what, he who killed Rue de la Huchette, a worthy man who wanted a fat fowl?'

'Yes, monsieur; the same.'

'And did this Menneville also cry, "Vive Colbert"?'

'Louder than all the rest; like a madman.'

Colbert's brow grew dark and wrinkled. A kind of ambitious glory which had lighted his face was extinguished, like the light of glow-worms we crush beneath the grass. 'Then you say,' resumed the deceived intend-ant, 'that the initiative came from the people? Menneville was my enemy; I would have had him hung; and he knew it well. Menneville belonged to the Abbé Fouquet—the affair originated with Fouquet; does not every-body know that the condemned were his friends from childhood?'

'That is true,' thought D'Arragnan, 'and thus are all my doubts cleared up. I repeat it, Monsieur Fouquet may be called what they please, but he is a very gentlemanly man.'

'And,' continued Colbert, 'are you quite sure Menneville is dead?'

D'Arragnan thought the time was come for him to make his appearance.

Perfectly, monsieur,' replied he, advancing suddenly.

'Oh! is that you, monsieur?' said Colbert.

'In person,' replied the musketeer with his deliberate tone; 'it appears that you had in Menneville a pretty enemy.'

'It was not I, monsieur, who had an enemy,' replied Colbert; 'it was the king.'

'Double brute!' thought D'Arragnan, 'to think to play the great man and the hypocrite with me. Well,' continued he to Colbert, 'I am very happy to have rendered so good a service to the king; will you take upon you to tell his majesty, monsieur l'intendant?'

'What commission is this you give me, and what do you charge me to tell his majesty, monsieur? Be precise, if you please,' said Colbert, in a sharp voice, tuned beforehand to hostility.

'I give you no commission,' replied D'Arragnan, with that calmness which never abandons the banterer; 'I thought it would be easy for you to announce to his majesty that it was I who, being there by chance, did justice upon Menneville and restored order to things.'

Colbert opened his eyes and interrogated the chief of the watch with a look—'Ah! it is very true,' said the latter, 'that this gentleman saved us.'

'Why did you not tell me, monsieur, that you came to relate me this?' said Colbert with envy; 'everything is explained, and more favourably for you than for anybody else.'

'You are in error, monsieur l'intendant; I did not at all come for the purpose of relating that to you.'

'It is an exploit, nevertheless.'

'Oh! said the musketeer carelessly, 'constant habit blunts the mind.'

'To what do I owe the honour of your visit, then?'

'Simply to this: the king ordered me to come to you.'

'Ah!' said Colbert, recovering himself when he saw D'Arragnan draw a paper from his pocket; 'it is to demand some money of me?'

'Precisely, monsieur.'

'Have the goodness to wait, if you please, monsieur, till I have dis-patched the report of the watch.'

D'Artagnan turned upon his heel, insolently enough, and finding himself face to face with Colbert, after his first turn, he bowed to him as a harlequin would have done; then, after a second evolution, he directed his steps towards the door in quick time. Colbert was struck with this pointed rudeness, to which he was not accustomed. In general, men of the sword, when they came to his office, had such a want of money, that though their feet seemed to take root in the marble, they hardly lost their patience. Was D'Artagnan going straight to the king? Would he go and describe his rough reception, or recount his exploit? This was a matter for grave consideration. At all events, the moment was badly chosen to send D'Artagnan away, whether he came from the king, or on his own account. The musketeer had rendered too great a service, and that too recently, for it to be already forgotten. Therefore Colbert thought it would be better to shake off his arrogance and call D'Artagnan back. 'Ho! Monsieur d'Artagnan,' cried Colbert, 'what! are you leaving me thus?'

D'Artagnan turned round: 'Why not?' said he, quietly, 'we have no more to say to each other, have we?'

'You have, at least, money to receive, as you have an order?'

'Who, I? Oh! not at all, my dear Monsieur Colbert.'

'But, monsieur, you have an order. And, in the same manner as you give a sword-thrust, when you are required, I, on my part, pay when an order is presented to me. Present yours.'

'It is useless, my dear Monsieur Colbert,' said D'Artagnan, who inwardly enjoyed this confusion in the ideas of Colbert; 'my order is paid.'

'Paid, by whom?'

'By monsieur le surintendant.'

Colbert grew pale.

'Explain yourself,' said he, in a stifled voice—'if you are paid why do you show me that paper?'

'In consequence of the word of order of which you spoke to me so ingeniously just now, dear M. Colbert; the king told me to take a quarter of the pension he is pleased to make me.'

'Of me?' said Colbert.

'Not exactly. The king said to me: "Go to M. Fouquet; the superintendent will, perhaps, have no money, then you will go and draw it of M. Colbert."'

Chapter LXIV

Difference D'Artagnan Finds Between the Intendant and the Superintendent



Colbert resided in the Rue Neuve des Petits-Champs, in a house which had belonged to Beaurru. D'Artagnan's legs cleared the distance in a short quarter of an hour. When he arrived at the residence of the new favourite, the court was full of archers and police, who came to congratulate him, or to excuse themselves, according to whether he should choose to praise or blame. The sentiment of flattery is instinctive with people of abject condition; they have the sense of it, as the wild animal has that of hearing and smell. These people, or their leader, understood that there was a pleasure to offer to M. Colbert, in rendering him an account of the fashion in which his name had been pronounced during the rash enterprise of the morning. D'Artagnan made his appearance just as the chief of the watch was giving his report. He stood close to the door, behind the archers. That officer took Colbert on one side, in spite of his resistance and the contradiction of his bushy eyebrows. 'In case,' said he, 'you really desired, monsieur, that the people should do justice on the two traitors, it would have been wise to warn us of it; for, indeed, monsieur, in spite of our regret at displeasing you, or thwarting your views, we had our orders to execute.'

'Triple fool!' replied Colbert, furiously shaking his hair, thick and black as a mane; 'what are you telling me? What! that I could have had an idea of a riot! Are you mad or drunk?'

'Therefore I will make no more, and will content myself with asking you a favour.'

'Oh, monsieur.'

Fouquet drew from his finger a ring worth about three thousand pistoles. 'Monsieur,' said he, 'this stone was given me by a friend of my childhood, by a man to whom you have rendered a great service.'

'A service—I?' said the musketeer; 'I have rendered a service to one of your friends?'

'You cannot have forgotten it, monsieur, for it dates this very day.'

'And that friend's name was—'

'M. d'Eymerys.'

'One of the condemned?'

'Yes, one of the victims. Well! Monsieur d'Aragnan, in return for the service you have rendered him, I beg you to accept this diamond. Do so for my sake.'

'Monsieur! you—'

'Accept it, I say. To-day is with me a day of mourning; hereafter you will, perhaps, learn why; to-day I have lost one friend; well, I will try to get another.'

'But, Monsieur Fouquet—'

'Adieu! Monsieur d'Aragnan, adieu!' cried Fouquet, with much emotion; 'or rather, au revoir.' And the minister quitted the cabinet, leaving in the hands of the musketeer the ring and the twenty thousand livres.

'Oh!' said D'Aragnan, after a moment's dark reflection. 'How on earth am I to understand what this means? *Mordieu!* I can understand this much, only: he is a gallant man! I will go and explain matters to M. Colbert.' And he went out.

The countenance of M. Colbert brightened for a moment; but it was with his unfortunate physiognomy as with a stormy sky, sometimes radiant, sometimes dark as night, according as the lightening gleams or the cloud passes. 'Eh! and was there any money in the superintendent's coffers?' asked he.

'Why, yes, he could not be badly off for money,' replied D'Aragnan—'it may be believed, since M. Fouquet, instead of paying me a quarter or five thousand livres—'

'A quarter or five thousand livres!' cried Colbert, struck, as Fouquet had been, with the generosity of the sum for a soldier's pension, 'why, that would be a pension of twenty thousand livres?'

'Exactly, M. Colbert. *Peste!* you reckon like old Pythagoras; yes, twenty thousand livres.'

'Ten times the appointment of an intendant of the finances. I beg to offer you my compliments,' said Colbert, with a vicious smile.

'Oh!' said D'Aragnan, 'the king apologized for giving me so little; but he promised to make it more hereafter, when he should be rich; but I must be gone, having much to do—'

'So, then, notwithstanding the expectation of the king, the superintendent paid you, did he?'

'In the same manner, as, in opposition to the king's expectation, you refused to pay me.'

'I did not refuse, monsieur, I only begged you to wait. And you say that M. Fouquet paid you your five thousand livres?'

'Yes, as you might have done; but he did even better than that, M. Colbert.'

'And what did he do?'

'He politely counted me down the sum-total, saying, that for the king, his coffers were always full.'

'The sum-total! M. Fouquet has given you twenty thousand livres instead of five thousand?'

'Yes, monsieur.'

'And what for?'

'In order to spare me three visits to the money-chest of the superintendent, so that I have the twenty thousand livres in my pocket in good new coin. You see, then, that I am able to go away without standing in need of

you, having come here only for form's sake.' And D'Artagnan slapped his hand upon his pocket, with a laugh which disclosed to Colbert thirty-two magnificent teeth, as white as teeth of twenty-five years old, and which seemed to say in their language: 'Serve up to us thirty-two little Colberts, and we will chew them willingly.' The serpent is as brave as the lion, the hawk as courageous as the eagle, that cannot be contested. It can only be said of animals that are decidedly cowardly, and are so called, that they will be brave only when they have to defend themselves. Colbert was not frightened at the thirty-two teeth of D'Artagnan. He recovered, and suddenly,—'Monsieur,' said he, 'monsieur le surintendant has done what he had no right to do.'

'What do you mean by that?' replied D'Artagnan.

'I mean that your note—will you let me see your note, if you please?'

'Very willingly; here it is.'

Colbert seized the paper with an eagerness which the musketeer did not remark without uneasiness, and particularly without a certain degree of regret at having trusted him with it. 'Well, monsieur, the royal order says thus:—"At sight, I command that there be paid to M. d'Artagnan the sum of five thousand livres, forming a quarter of the pension I have made him."'

'So, in fact, it is written,' said D'Artagnan, affecting calmness.

'Very well; the king only owed you five thousand livres; why has more been given to you?'

'Because there was more; and M. Fouquet was willing to give me more; that does not concern anybody.'

'It is natural,' said Colbert with a proud ease, 'that you should be ignorant of the usages of state-finance; but, monsieur, when you have a thousand livres to pay, what do you do?'

'I never have a thousand livres to pay,' replied D'Artagnan.

'Once more,' said Colbert, irritated—'once more, if you had any sum to pay, would you not pay what you ought?'

'That only proves one thing,' said D'Artagnan; 'and that is, that you have your own particular customs in finance, and M. Fouquet has his own.'

'Mine, monsieur, are the correct ones.'

'I do not say that they are not.'

'Give it me, I will pay you myself; come with me.' He made a sign to Gourville and the Abbé, who remained in the chamber where they were. He led D'Artagnan into his cabinet. As soon as the door was shut,—'how much is due to you, monsieur?'

'Why, something like five thousand livres, monseigneur.'

'For arrears of pay?'

'For a quarter's pay.'

'A quarter consisting of five thousand livres!' said Fouquet, fixing upon the musketeer a searching look. 'Does the king, then, give you twenty thousand livres a year?'

'Yes, monseigneur, twenty thousand livres a year. Do you think it is too much?'

'?' cried Fouquet, and he smiled bitterly. 'If I had any knowledge of mankind, if I were—instead of being a frivolous, inconsequent, and vain spirit—of a prudent and reflective spirit; if, in a word, I had, as certain persons have known how, regulated my life, you would not receive twenty thousand livres a year, but a hundred thousand, and you would belong not to the king but to me.'

D'Artagnan coloured slightly. There is sometimes in the manner in which a eulogium is given, in the voice, in the affectionate tone, a poison so sweet, that the strongest mind is intoxicated by it. The superintendent terminated his speech by opening a drawer, and taking from it four rouleaux, which he placed before D'Artagnan. The Gascon opened one. 'Gold!' said he.

'It will be less burdensome, monsieur.'

'But, then, monsieur, these make twenty thousand livres.'

'No doubt they do.'

'But only five are due to me.'

'I wish to spare you the trouble of coming four times to my office.'

'You overwhelm me, monsieur.'

'I do only what I ought to do, monsieur le chevalier; and I hope you will not bear me any malice on account of the rude reception my brother gave you. He is of a sour, capricious disposition.'

'Monsieur,' said D'Artagnan, 'believe me, nothing would grieve me more than an excuse from you.'

'My dear Monsieur Gourville, put yourself in my place. I was an agent of the public force and a landlord, too. As a captain, it is my duty to have the orders of the king accomplished. As a proprietor, it is to my interest my house should not be burnt. I have at the same time attended to the laws of interest and duty in replacing Messieurs Lyodot and D'Eymetis in the hands of the archers.'

'Then it was you who threw the man out of the window?'

'It was I, myself,' replied D'Artagnan, modestly.

'And you who killed Menneville?'

'I had that misfortune,' said D'Artagnan, bowing like a man who is being congratulated.

'It was you, then, in short, who caused the two condemned persons to be hung?'

'Instead of being burnt, yes, monsieur, and I am proud of it. I saved the poor devils from horrible tortures. Understand, my dear Monsieur de Gourville, that they wanted to burn them alive. It exceeds imagination!'

'Go, my dear Monsieur d'Artagnan, go,' said Gourville, anxious to spare Fouquet the sight of the man who had just caused him such profound grief.

'No,' said Fouquet, who had heard all from the door of the ante-chamber; 'not so; on the contrary, Monsieur d'Artagnan, come in.'

D'Artagnan wiped from the hilt of his sword a last bloody trace, which had escaped his notice, and returned. He then found himself face to face with these three men, whose countenances wore very different expressions. With the Abbé it was anger, with Gourville stupor, with Fouquet it was dejection.

'I beg your pardon, monsieur le ministre,' said D'Artagnan, 'but my time is short; I have to go to the office of the intendant, to have an explanation with Monsieur Colbert, and to receive my quarter's pension.'

'But, monsieur,' said Fouquet, 'there is money here.' D'Artagnan looked at the superintendent with astonishment. 'You have been answered inconsiderately, monsieur, I know, because I heard it,' said the minister; 'a man of your merit ought to be known by everybody.' D'Artagnan bowed. 'Have you an order?' added Fouquet.

'Yes, monsieur.'

'And you have accepted what was not due to you.'
D'Artagnan's eyes flashed. 'What is not due to me yet, you meant to say, M. Colbert; for if I have received what was not due to me at all, I should have committed a theft.'

Colbert made no reply to this subtlety. 'You then owe fifteen thousand livres to the public chest,' said he, carried away by his jealous ardour.

'Then you must give me credit for them,' replied D'Artagnan, with his imperceptible irony.

'Not at all, monsieur.'

'Well! what will you do, then? You will not take my rouleaux from me, will you?'

'You must return them to my chest.'

'I! Oh! Monsieur Colbert, don't reckon upon that.'

'The king wants his money, monsieur.'

'And I, monsieur, I want the king's money.'

'That may be so; but you must return this.'

'Not a sou. I have always understood that in matters of comptabilité, as you call it, a good cashier never gives back or takes back.'

'Then, monsieur, we shall see what the king will say about it. I will show him this note, which proves that M. Fouquet not only pays what he does not owe, but that he does not even take care of vouchers for the sums that he has paid.'

'Ah! now I understand why you have taken that paper, M. Colbert!'

Colbert did not perceive all that there was of a threatening character in his name pronounced in a certain manner. 'You shall see hereafter what use I will make of it,' said he, holding up the paper in his fingers.

'Oh!' said D'Artagnan, snatching the paper from him with a rapid movement; 'I understand perfectly well, M. Colbert; I have no occasion to wait for that.' And he crumpled up the paper he had so cleverly seized.

'Monsieur, monsieur!' cried Colbert, 'this is violence!'

'Nonsense! You must not be particular about a soldier's manners!' replied D'Artagnan. 'I kiss your hands, my dear M. Colbert.' And he went out, laughing in the face of the future minister.

'That man, now,' muttered he, 'was about to grow quite friendly; it is a great pity I was obliged to cut his company so soon.'

Chapter 63: How M. d'Eymery's Diamond Came To M. d'Arragnan

'Permit me then, monseigneur, to announce your refusal to him; for he is one of my acquaintance, and is a man whom, in our present circumstances, it would be better to have as a friend than an enemy.'

'Answer him as you please,' said Fouquet.

'Eh! good Lord!' said the Abbé, still full of malice, like an egotistical man; 'tell him there is no money, particularly for musketeers.'

But scarcely had the Abbé uttered this imprudent speech, when the partly open door was thrown back, and D'Arragnan appeared.

'Eh! Monsieur Fouquet,' said he, 'I was well aware there was no money for musketeers here. Therefore I did not come to obtain any, but to have it refused. That being done, receive my thanks. I give you good-day, and will go and seek it at M. Colbert's.' And he went out, making an easy bow.

'Gourville,' said Fouquet, 'run after that man and bring him back.' Gourville obeyed, and overtook D'Arragnan on the stairs.

D'Arragnan, hearing steps behind him, turned round and perceived Gourville. '*Mordieu!* my dear monsieur,' said he, 'there are sad lessons which you gentlemen of finance teach us; I come to M. Fouquet to receive a sum accorded by his majesty, and I am received like a mendicant who comes to ask charity, or a thief who comes to steal a piece of plate.'

'But you pronounced the name of M. Colbert, my dear M. d'Arragnan; you said you were going to M. Colbert's?'

'I certainly am going there, were it only to ask satisfaction of the people who try to burn houses, crying "*Vive Colbert!*"'

Gourville pricked up his ears. 'Oh, oh!' said he, 'you allude to what has just happened at the Grève?'

'Yes, certainly.'

'And in what did that which has taken place concern you?'

'What! do you ask me whether it concerns me or does not concern me, if M. Colbert pleases to make a funeral-pile of my house?'

'So, ho, your house—was it your house they wanted to burn?'

'*Pardieu!* was it!'

'Is the cabaret of the Image-de-Notre-Dame yours, then?'

'It has been this week.'

'Well, then, are you the brave captain, are you the valiant blade who dispersed those who wished to burn the condemned?'

who had remained motionless, advanced with a rapid step and stood between the Abbé and Gourville. Both of them at the same time opened their mouths to speak to him. 'No excuses,' said he, 'no recriminations against anybody. If I had not been a false friend I should not have confided to any one the care of delivering Lyodot and D'Eymerys. I alone am guilty; to me alone are reproaches and remorse due. Leave me, Abbé.'

'And yet, monsieur, you will not prevent me,' replied the latter, 'from endeavouring to find out the miserable fellow who has intervened to the advantage of M. Colbert in this so well-arranged affair; for, if it is good policy to love our friends dearly, I do not believe that is bad which consists in obstinately pursuing our enemies.'

'A truce to policy, Abbé; begone, I beg of you, and do not let me hear any more of you till I send for you; what we most need is circumspection and silence. You have a terrible example before you, gentlemen: no reprisals, I forbid them.'

'There are no orders,' grumbled the Abbé, 'which will prevent me from avenging a family affront upon the guilty person.'

'And I,' cried Fouquet, in that imperative tone to which one feels there is nothing to reply, 'if you entertain one thought, one single thought, which is not the absolute expression of my will, I will have you cast into the Bastille two hours after that thought has manifested itself. Regulate your conduct accordingly, Abbé.'

The Abbé coloured and bowed. Fouquet made a sign to Gourville to follow him, and was already directing his steps towards his cabinet, when the usher announced with a loud voice: 'Monsieur le Chevalier d'Artagnan.'

'Who is he?' said Fouquet, negligently, to Gourville.

'An ex-lieutenant of his majesty's musketeers,' replied Gourville, in the same tone. Fouquet did not even take the trouble to reflect, and resumed his walk. 'I beg your pardon, monseigneur!' said Gourville, 'but I have remembered; this brave man has quitted the king's service, and probably comes to receive an instalment of some pension or other.'

'Devil take him!' said Fouquet, 'why does he choose his opportunity so ill?'

Chapter LXV

Philosophy of the Heart and Mind



OR a man who had seen so many much more dangerous ones, the position of D'Artagnan with respect to M. Colbert was only comic. D'Artagnan, therefore, did not deny himself the satisfaction of laughing at the expense of monsieur l'intendant, from the Rue des Petits-Champs to the Rue des Lombards. It was a great while since D'Artagnan had laughed so long together. He was still laughing when Planchet appeared, laughing likewise, at the door of his house; for Planchet, since the return of his patron, since the entrance of the English guineas, passed the greater part of his life in doing what D'Artagnan had only done from the Rue Neuve des Petits-Champs to the Rue des Lombards.

'You are home, then, my dear master?' said Planchet.

'No, my friend,' replied the musketeer, 'I am off, and that quickly. I will sup with you, go to bed, sleep five hours, and at break of day leap into my saddle. Has my horse had an extra feed?'

'Eh! my dear master,' replied Planchet, 'you know very well that your horse is the jewel of the family; that my lad's are caressing it all day, and cramming it with sugar, nuts, and biscuits. You ask me if he has had an extra feed of oats; you should ask if he has not had enough to burst him.'

'Very well, Planchet, that is all right. Now, then, I pass to what concerns me—my supper?'

'Ready. A smoking roast joint, white wine, crayfish, and fresh-gathered cherries. All ready, my master.'

'You are a capital fellow, Planchet; come on, then, let us sup, and I will go to bed.'

During supper D'Aragnan observed that Planchet kept rubbing his forehead, as if to facilitate the issue of some idea closely pent within his brain. He looked with an air of kindness at this worthy companion of former adventures and misadventures, and, clinking glass against glass, 'Come, Planchet,' said he, 'let us see what it is that gives you so much trouble to bring forth. *Mordieu!* Speak freely, and quickly.'

'Well, this is it,' replied Planchet: 'you appear to me to be going on some expedition or another.'

'I don't say that I am not.'

'Then you have some new idea?'

'That is possible, too, Planchet.'

'Then there will be fresh capital to be ventured? I will lay down fifty thousand livres upon the idea you are about to carry out.' And so saying, Planchet rubbed his hands one against the other with a rapidity evincing great delight.

'Planchet,' said D'Aragnan, 'there is but one misfortune in it.'

'And what is that?'

'That the idea is not mine. I can risk nothing upon it.'

These words drew a deep sigh from the heart of Planchet. That Avarice is an ardent counsellor; she carries away her man, as Satan did Jesus, to the mountain, and when once she has shown to an unfortunate all the kingdoms of the earth, she is able to repose herself, knowing full well that she has left her companion, Envy, to gnaw at his heart. Planchet had tasted of riches easily acquired, and was never afterwards likely to stop in his desires; but, as he had a good heart in spite of his covetousness, as he adored D'Aragnan, he could not refrain from making him a thousand recommendations, each more affectionate than the others. He would not have been sorry, nevertheless, to have caught a little hint of the secret his master concealed so well; tricks, turns, counsels, and traps were all useless, D'Aragnan let nothing confidential escape him. The evening passed thus. After supper the portmanteau occupied D'Aragnan, he took a turn to the stable, patted his horse, and examined his shoes and legs; then, having counted over his money, he went to bed, sleeping as if only twenty, because he had neither inquietude nor remorse; he closed

'Granted, monsieur, granted,' said the man, looking into the eyes and the faces of the two interlocutors, to ascertain what there was profitable or disadvantageous to himself in telling the truth.

'Now, proceed,' said Gourville.

'The prisoners,' cried Danicamp, 'were brought to the Grève, and the people, in a fury, insisted upon their being burnt instead of being hung.'

'And the people were right,' said the Abbé. 'Go on.'

'But,' resumed the man, 'at the moment the archers were broken, at the moment the fire was set to one of the houses of the Place destined to serve as a funeral-pile for the guilty, this fury, this demon, this giant of whom I told you, and who, we had been informed, was the proprietor of the house in question, aided by a young man who accompanied him, threw out of the window those who kept the fire, called to his assistance the musketeers who were in the crowd, leaped himself from the window of the first story into the Place, and plied his sword so desperately that the victory was restored to the archers, the prisoners were retaken, and Menneville killed. When once recaptured, the condemned were executed in three minutes. Fouquet, in spite of his self-command, could not prevent a deep groan escaping him.'

'And this man, the proprietor of the house, what is his name?' said the Abbé.

'I cannot tell you, not having even been able to get sight of him; my post had been appointed in the garden, and I remained at my post: only the affair was related to me as I repeat it. I was ordered, when once the affair was at an end, to come at best speed and announce to you the manner in which it finished. According to this order, I set out, full gallop, and here I am.'

'Very well, monsieur, we have nothing else to ask of you,' said the Abbé, more and more dejected, in proportion as the moment approached for finding himself alone with his brother.

'Have you been paid?' asked Gourville.

'Partly, monsieur,' replied Danicamp.

'Here are twenty pistols. Begone, monsieur, and never forget to defend, as this time has been done, the true interests of the king.'

'Yes, monsieur,' said the man, bowing and pocketing the money. After which he went out. Scarcely had the door closed after him when Fouquet,